INCH-POUND

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DETAIL SPECIFICATION

ANTENNAS, UHF, SATCOM, PORTABLE, FOLDABLE, (LIGHT WEIGHT, MEDIUM WEIGHT, AND HEAVY DUTY), GENERAL SPECIFICATION FOR

Inactive for new design after 4 June 1999.

This specification is approved for use by the Department of the Army and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification establishes the performance, manufacture, test, and inspection requirements for three UHF SATCOM portable antenna types that are used with a family of UHF SATCOM transceivers. The transceivers are of the manpack and vehicular type.

1.2 Note. The required first article and conformance testing for prototype and production antennas is contained in section 4 of this specification. However, the Government, when deemed necessary, should reserve the right to inspect and test deliverable production antennas beyond the stated percentages. Any deliverable antenna should comply with all the requirements of these technical specifications and with the applicable specification sheet.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 General. The documents listed in this section are specified in sections 3 and 4 of this specification. This section does not include documents cited in other sections of this specification or recommended for additional information or as examples. While every effort has been made to ensure the completeness of this list, document users are cautioned that they must meet all specified requirements of documents cited in sections 3 and 4 of this specification, whether or not they are listed.

2.2 Government documents.

2.2.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. The following specifications, standards, and handbooks form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those cited in the solicitation or contract.

Comments, suggestions or questions on this document should be addressed to Defense Supply Center Columbus, ATTN: VAT, Post Office Box 3990, Columbus, OH 43218-3990), or emailed to TubesAmps@dla.mil. Since contact information can change, you may want to verify the currency of this address information using the ASSIST Online database at http://assist.daps.dla.mil.

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FEDERAL STANDARDS

FED-STD-595/37038-Colors Used in Government Procurement.

DEPARTMENT OF DEFENSE STANDARDS

MIL-STD-810 - Environmental Engineering Considerations and Laboratory Tests.

MIL-STD-882 - System Safety.

MIL-STD-13231 - Marking of Electronic Items.

(Copies of these documents are available online at http://assist.daps.dla.mil or from the Standardization Document Order Desk, 700 Robbins Avenue, Building 4D, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.).

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein (except for related specification sheets), the text of this document takes precedence. Nothing in this document, however, supersedes applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Specification sheets. The individual item requirements shall be as specified herein and in accordance with the applicable specification sheet. In the event of any conflict between the requirements of this specification and the specification sheet, the latter shall govern.

3.2 Item definition. The foldable, portable SATCOM antenna, also referred to as the antenna or the item, may be any configuration, such as a crossed dipole, helix, logarithmic periodic, or related types, using either equal length or tapered director arrays. The SATCOM antenna shall consist of the following major components:

a. Antenna element (boom, ground plane, or array), foldable.

b. Tripod.

c. RF cables.

d. Operator's and maintenance manual.

e. Carrying case, for storage of above items.

3.3 Electrical requirements. The antenna shall comply with the following electrical requirements over a minimum bandwidth of 244 to 318 MHz.

3.3.1 RF cables. The antenna shall be supplied with two identical low attenuation 50 ohm RF cables. Each cable shall be 12.5 feet long and shall serve as an extension of the other.

3.3.2 Antenna RF connector. The antenna connector shall be a type "BNC" male, coaxial cable connector. The connector shall mate with any of the cables of 3.3.1 and shall provide reliable operation in all climates and weather. The connector shall be accessible and easily operable with arctic gloves.

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3.3.3 Polarization. Polarization shall be right-handed circular.

3.3.4 Gain patterns, cpi. The contractor shall record and demonstrate the circularly polarized gain patterns for 360 degrees rotation about the antenna azimuth and elevation axes at the following frequencies: 244, 260, 280, 300, and 318 MHz. These measurements shall be performed with a circularly polarized source antenna.

3.3.5 Gain patterns, linear. The recording of gain patterns shall be repeated with a linearly polarized antenna source at 244 and 318 MHz only.

3.3.6 Axial ratio. The antenna axial ratio shall not exceed 3 dB at the half power point of the beam.

3.3.7 RF conductivity of folding joints. The electrical RF conductivity of the folding joints shall remain unaffected by deployment and teardown operations during military exercises undertaken over ten years in various field environments. The RF energy, traveling on the surface of conductors, shall not be attenuated by insulating materials or build up of metal oxides or corrosion at mechanical joint interfaces.

3.3.8 Impedance. The antenna impedance shall be 50 ohms.

3.3.9 Antenna VSWR. The antenna VSWR shall be 1.5:1 maximum over the specified frequency range.

3.3.10 Half power beam width. The nominal half power beam width of the antenna shall be 80 degrees.

3.3.11 Side lobes. Side lobes shall be at least 10 dB below the peak gain of the main lobe.

3.3.12 Power handling. The antenna shall not be damaged when driven for 15 minutes at a CW power level of 100 watts at any frequency in the range from 225 to 400 MHz.

3.4 Mechanical requirements. The antenna shall meet the following physical requirements.

3.4.1 Mechanical freedom. The antenna shall be mounted on a tripod that shall permit azimuth and elevation adjustments of the antenna.

3.4.1.1 Elevation freedom. Elevation angle shall be adjustable from horizon to 70 degrees above the horizon. Ten degree steps are acceptable.

3.4.1.2 Azimuth freedom. Azimuth freedom shall be at least ±180 degrees by repositioning the tripod legs or by AZ rotation.

3.4.2 Antenna folding. The antenna tripod legs as well as the antenna elements and ground plane rods, shall snugly and easily fold down near the major boom, without the need for releasing a number of triggers and without mutual element interference.

3.4.3 Ease of handling. Deployment of the antenna as well as teardown shall be accomplished easily with arctic gloves worn by the operator.

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3.4.4 Antenna and tripod mechanical interface. The tripod shall be capable of being disengaged from the antenna when the antenna is to be mounted on a vehicular or shelter mount that has a mechanical interface, ending in a fiberglass tube of the following dimensions: Outside diameter = 1.600 inches (40.64 mm), inside diameter = 1.437 inches (36.50 mm) and a minimum length of 24 inches (609 mm). The tolerance of these measurements shall be .005 inches (0.13 mm).

3.4.5 Telescoping tubes. Antenna and tripod rods, directors, dipoles, and legs of the telescoping type shall not be acceptable in this design because ice crystals, which may cause mechanical jamming and damage during stowing procedure, form inside the tubes in winter time.

3.4.6 Antenna-tripod adapter.

a. The antenna-tripod adapter shall remain with the antenna when the tripod is disengaged from the antenna.

b. The adapter shall not be an obstruction to the requirement of snugly folding down the antenna elements near the center section.

3.4.7 Transport configuration. The antenna with tripod shall be capable of being folded in a compact manner for ease of storage and transport in its carrying case.

3.4.8 Antenna carrying case. The antenna carrying case shall accept the antenna element, tripod, two cables and instruction manual. The carrying case material shall be thermoformed plastic or fiberglass that can survive 10 years of military operation in any geographical area and climate. The cover shall be hinged to the case.

3.4.9 Padding for carrying case. The carrying case shall be properly padded to prevent damage to the antenna items during military transportation handling.

3.4.10 Ballast. The antenna tripod shall be equipped with a device near its base that can be loaded with the ballast such as logs or rocks, when necessary, to keep the center of gravity as low as possible and to keep the antenna stable in the operating wind requirements of this specification.

3.4.11 Set-up/tear-down for tripod mode. The antenna shall be designed and built such that erection and orientation to any given coordinates shall be accomplished by one person in less than three minutes on flat surface, with arctic gloves worn by the operator. Repacking shall be achieved in the same time under the same conditions.

3.4.12 Field environment. The antenna shall be designed to be deployed in the military tactical field, in darkness, on slopes of 15 degrees and on rugged, uneven terrain or in jungle. No small, loose components are acceptable.

3.4.13 Design life. The antenna shall be designed to survive 1,000 set-up/tear-down cycles per year for 10 years.

3.5 Environmental conditions. The antenna shall be designed for storage and operation in climate design types "Hot", "Basic", and "Cold" as outlined in MIL-STD-810.

3.5.1 Equipment non-operating. The item (in carrying case) and all antenna components separately shall comply with all requirements of this specification after undergoing any of the conditions specified below.

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3.5.1.1 Temperature. The antenna shall withstand continuous exposure to air temperature from -65°F for periods up to 24 hours daily to +160°F for 4 hours daily.

3.5.1.2 Relative humidity. As specified in MIL-STD-810 for climate design types "Hot", "Basic", and "Cold".

3.5.1.3 Rain. The antenna shall withstand a rainfall rate of 4.0 inches (101.6 mm) per hour.

3.5.1.4 Altitude. The antenna shall withstand an altitude up to 50,000 feet above sea level.

3.5.1.5 Salt/fog atmosphere. The antenna shall withstand a salt/fog atmosphere as encountered during coastal service.

3.5.1.6 Vibration, shock, and bounce. The antenna shall withstand vibration, shock, and bounce as encountered in military ground transportation by rail, highways and unimproved roads and by fixed and rotary winged aircraft. The antenna, in its padded carrying case, shall withstand shipment as loose cargo in wheeled and tracked vehicles.

3.5.1.7 Bench handling. The antenna in its servicing condition shall withstand bench handling shocks.

3.5.1.8 Tropical conditions/fungus. The antenna shall withstand tropical conditions including fungus-laden air. Prolonged periods of exposure to a fungus growth environment shall not result in evidence of fungus growth on any surface whether internal or external. Fungus-resistant materials shall be used (see 6.2).

3.5.1.9 Blowing sand and dust. The antenna shall withstand the following:

a. Blowing sand particles of 0.01 to 1.0 millimeters in diameter, driven by 5,700 feet per minute (fpm) (56 knots) winds.

b. Blowing dust particles 0.0001 to 0.01 millimeters in diameter driven by 1,750 fpm (17 knots) winds.

3.5.1.10 Icing. The antenna shall be operable and shall sustain no physical damage when subjected to icing accumulations of .500 inch (12.7 mm) of clear ice with a density of 0.85 gm/cm^3

3.5.1.11 Sea water. The antenna shall withstand submersion in 3 feet of sea water for a period of two hours.

3.5.2 Equipment operating. The antenna shall comply with all requirements of this specification, while undergoing any of the conditions specified below.

3.5.2.1 Temperature. From -50°F to +125°F (plus the effects of solar radiation of 355 British thermal units per square foot per hour at 125°F).

3.5.2.2 Relative humidity. Same as non-operating.

3.5.2.3 Rain. Same as non-operating.

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3.5.2.4 Altitude. The antenna shall also be operable without degradation in specified performance at altitudes up to 15,000 feet above sea level.

3.5.2.5 Salt atmosphere. Same as non-operating.

3.5.2.6 Tropical conditions/fungus. Same as non-operating.

3.5.2.7 Blowing sand and dust. Same as non-operating.

3.5.2.8 Wind. The antenna, with an accumulation of .250 inch (6.35 mm) of clear glaze ice, shall be operable and shall sustain no physical damage during winds of 45 knots for a 5-minute period with gusts to 65 knots while standing alone. Hold-down facilities shall permit the antenna to withstand winds of 80 knots.

3.6 Interchangeability. All parts and basic subassemblies of the antenna shall be interchangeable between antennas of different serial numbers, of the same antenna type (see 6.2).

3.7 Safety. The safety characteristics of the antenna shall be consistent with MIL-STD-882. RF radiation signs shall be permanently affixed to the antenna, stating the maximum distance of the RF radiation hazard zones. Antenna element tips shall have tip caps or other suitable design features to minimize puncture hazard to eyes.

3.8 External protective finish. The antenna shall be given a protective finish as follows. The final paint film on type 1 surface shall be dull black polyurethane color No. 37038 in accordance with FED-STD-595. All materials and finishes shall be resistant to the effects of standard decontamination agents such as STB, hot soapy water, germicidal soap and 5 percent washing soda solution. Marking RADIATION HAZARD labels shall be provided. All carrying case surfaces shall likewise be of dull black color.

3.9 Product identification.

3.9.1 General. Marking and identification shall conform to MIL-STD-13231; the equipment shall be considered air-transportable. Reference designation shall be assigned and marked.

3.9.2 Visibility. Wherever practicable, parts shall be marked so that when mounted, their identification marking will be readily visible with minimum disassembly of the equipment.

3.9.3 Serial numbers. Serial numbers as specified by the contracting officer shall be assigned to all units.

3.9.4 Nameplates. Nameplates shall be provided for the antenna assembly.

3.10 Parts, materials, and processes. Parts, materials, and processes shall be selected to meet or exceed requirements of this specification.

3.11 Reliability. The item shall have a MTBF (Mean Time Between Failures) of at least 25,000 hours. A failure of this equipment is defined as any interruption of performance or deviation from performance as specified.

3.12 Human factors engineering. The equipment shall be designed to enable configurations which are human engineered for efficient relationships between man and machine (see 6.2).

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3.13 First article. Two sample antennas of each type of the first production series shall be subjected to first article testing in accordance with section 4 of this specification.

3.14 Pure tin. The use of pure tin, as an underplate or final finish, is prohibited both internally and externally. Tin content of antenna components and of solder shall not exceed 97 percent, by mass. Tin shall be alloyed with a minimum 3 percent lead, by mass (see 6.4).

3.15 Workmanship. All details of workmanship shall be in accordance with the best manufacturing practice for high-quality electronic equipment. Particular attention shall be given to neatness and thoroughness in the making of parts, plating, soldering, and finishing.

4. VERIFICATION

4.1 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.2).

b. Conformance inspection (see 4.3).

4.2 First article inspection. First article inspection shall be performed on each SATCOM antenna type. This inspection shall encompass the examination of 4.4 and the tests of 4.5.1 through 4.5.3.

4.3 Conformance inspection. Conformance inspection shall include the examination of 4.5 and the tests of 4.5.4 and 4.5.5.

4.4 Examination. Each antenna shall be examined or tested for compliance with the requirements specified in section 3. Any redesign or modification of the contractor's standard product to comply with specified requirements, or any necessary redesign or modification following failure to meet the specified requirements shall receive particular attention for adequacy and suitability. This element of inspection shall encompass all visual examinations and dimensional measurements. Noncompliance with any specified requirements or presence of one or more defects preventing or lessening maximum efficiency shall constitute cause for rejection.

4.5 Methods of inspection.

4.5.1 First article acceptance testing and inspection. A detailed instrumented test program using the developed test procedures shall be conducted to demonstrate compliance with all requirements of section 3 and section 5 of this specification and the applicable specification sheet.

4.5.2 Environmental tests (first article). The antenna shall be subjected to the following tests of MIL-STD-810:

a. Low temperature: Method 502.2, procedure 5, I and II.

b. High temperature: Method 501.2, procedure 5, I and II.

c. Humidity: Method 507.2, procedure III.

d. Rain: Method 506.2, procedure I.

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e. Altitude: Method 500.2, procedure I.

f. Salt fog: Method 509.2, procedure I.

g. Vibration: Method 514.3, procedure II-2.

h. Bench handling: Method 516.3, procedure VI.

i. Shock: Method 516.3, procedure II.

j. Sand and Dust: Method 510.2, procedure 5, I and II.

k. Icing: Method 521.0, section I -1, see also 3.5.2.8.

l. Fresh water: Method 512.2, procedure I.

m. Sea water: See 3.5.1.11.

n. Wind: See 3.5.2.8.

4.5.3 Reliability (first article). The equipment reliability compliance shall be determined by analysis.

4.5.4 Production acceptance testing. The instrumented test program will consist of the specific tests identified in table II of this specification and shall be identical to the corresponding first article tests. The percentages listed refer to the percent of production units which shall be tested. Test candidate production units selected for production test shall be evenly distributed throughout the production run if the percentage is less than 100 percent.

TABLE II. Production acceptance test matrix.

Ref. paragraph	Test title	Sample
	Polarization	
3.3.3	AZ/EL patterns, cpi, calibrated	5%
3.3.4	AZ/EL patterns with linear source,	5% 1/
3.3.5	calibrated	5% 1/
3.3.6	Axial ratio	5%
3.3.8	Impedance	5%
3.3.9	VSWR	20%
3.3.11	Side lobes	5%
3.3.12	Power handling	5%
3.4.11	Demo setup/Tear down	5%
3.5.2.8	Exposure to 80 knot wind	5%

1/ Required gain is stated on the applicable specification sheet.

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4.5.5 Production acceptance inspection. Visual, mechanical, and related inspections will consist of the specific inspections identified in table III of this specification and shall be identical to the corresponding first article inspections. The percentages listed refer to the percent of production units which shall be inspected. Test candidate production units selected for production inspection shall be evenly distributed throughout the production run if the percentage is less than 100 percent.

TABLE III. Production acceptance inspection matrix.

Ref. paragraph	Test title	Sample
3.2(a) -(e)	Components	5%
3.3.2	Antenna RF connector	5%
3.3.7	RF conductivity of folding joints	5%
3.4	Mechanical requirements	5%
3.6	Interchangeability	5%
3.7	Safety	100%
3.8	External protective finish	5%
3.9	Product Identification	5%
3.9.2	Visibility	5%
3.9.3	Serial numbers	100%
3.9.4	Nameplates	50%
3.10	Parts, materials, and processes	5%
3.12	Human factors engineering	5%
3.14	Workmanship	5%
Spec sheet	Length of package	5%
Spec sheet	Weight of package	5%

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packaging. For acquisition purposes, the packaging requirements shall be as specified in the contract or order (see 6.2). When packaging of materiel is to be performed by DoD or in-house contractor personnel, these personnel need to contact the responsible packaging activity to ascertain packaging requirements. Packaging requirements are maintained by the Inventory Control Point's packaging activities within the Military Service or Defense Agency, or within the military service's system commands. Packaging data retrieval is available from the managing Military Department's or Defense Agency's automated packaging files, CD-ROM products, or by contacting the responsible packaging activity.

6. NOTES

(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature that may be helpful, but is not mandatory.)

6.1 Intended use. The antenna is intended to be used during rapid deployment type of operations in tactical global military environments of all climates. A prime requirement for this antenna is to be air deployed and to provide for a satellite communication link within three minutes after touch-down from a hovering helicopter. The antenna, when operationally deployed, will function as an integral part of a small tactical UHF satellite communications ground terminal such as the AN/PSC-3, HST-4A, LST-5B, or AN/URC-110.

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6.2 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of the specification.

b. Fungus-resistant materials: accordance with guidance from MIL-HDBK-454 guideline 4 (see 3.5.1.8).

c. Interchangeability: for guidance reference to MIL-HDBK-454, guideline 7 (see 3.6).

d. Human factors engineering : for guidance reference to MIL-HDBK-454, guideline 62 (see 3.12).

e. Packaging (see 5.1).

6.3 Subject term (keyword) listing.

Ground Mobile Forces Satellite Aerial

6.4 Tin whisker growth. The use of alloys with tin content greater than 97 percent, by mass, may exhibit tin whisker growth problems after manufacture. Tin whiskers may occur anytime from a day to years after manufacture and can develop under typical operating conditions, on products that use such materials. Conformal coatings applied over top of a whisker-prone surface will not prevent the formation of tin whiskers. Alloys of 3 percent lead, by mass, have shown to inhibit the growth of tin whiskers (see 3.14). For additional information on this matter, refer to ASTM-B545 (Standard Specification for Electrodeposited Coatings of Tin).

6.5. Environmentally preferable material. Environmentally preferable materials should be used to the maximum extent possible to meet the requirements of this specification. As of the dating of this document, the U.S. Environmentally Protection Agency (EPA) is focusing efforts on reducing 31 priority chemicals. The list of chemicals is available on their website at http://www.epa.gov/epaoswer/hazwaste/minimize/chemlist.htm. Further information is available at the following EPA site: http://www.epa.gov/epaoswer/hazwaste/minimize/. Included in the EPA list of 31 priority chemicals are cadmium, lead, and mercury. Use of the materials on the list should be minimized or eliminated unless needed to meet the requirements specified herein (see Section 3).

6.6 Changes from previous issue. The margins of this specification are marked with vertical lines to indicate where changes from the previous issue were made. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the last previous issue.

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